

RAYLEE HAWKINS

SOC Analyst | Detection Engineering | Security Automation

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Detection engineer and SOC automation builder who designed, built, and operates SignalFoundry — a production-grade 7-stage SOC triage pipeline processing 49,774 ledger-verified cases across 8 monitored endpoints with 8/8 host coverage, zero reconciliation mismatches, and 2,478 published analyst-ready evidence packs. Infrastructure runs on a role-segmented Proxmox environment (dual Xeon E5-2697 v4, 2 TiB RAM, Tesla V100 32GB, 8 active VMs) donated by a 25-year IT veteran after observing the work firsthand. Detection inventory includes 103 Sigma rules across 10 ATT&CK tactics, 28 Wazuh XML rule blocks, 8 Splunk SPL queries, and 10 structured IR playbooks — 139 total detection artifacts. Prior career: Tier 1 automotive production supervisor (IATF 16949, 30+ operators, 12-hr shifts, Nissan/Honda/Mercedes/BMW supply chain). The domain changed. The control logic, escalation discipline, and documentation instinct did not. CompTIA Security+ exam scheduled April 2026. Eligible to obtain clearance. Willing to pursue sponsorship. Targeting Huntsville, AL SOC/detection engineering roles.

49,774	8/8	0	2,478	139	277+
Cases Processed	Host Coverage	Recon Mismatches	Evidence Packs	Detection Artifacts	GitHub Commits

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- Detection EngineeringSigma rule authoring (103 rules, 10 ATT&CK tactics), Wazuh XML rule blocks (28), MITRE ATT&CK mapping, behavioral detection logic, false-positive tuning, rule lifecycle management
- SIEM / ToolingWazuh (manager + agent deployment, rule authoring, alert correlation), Splunk (SPL query building, index configuration, 4688 process creation hunting, field extraction via rex), Grafana (monitoring dashboards)
- SOC OperationsAlert triage, case management, escalation logic, evidence packaging, IR playbook execution, post-incident analysis, reconciliation discipline, SOC handoff documentation
- Threat HuntingLive Splunk hunting on own endpoints — EventID 4688 process creation analysis, parent-process exclusion logic, behavioral anomaly classification; identified Codex AI tool spawning pwsh.exe 375x (correctly classified vs LOLBin abuse)
- Languages / ScriptingPython (35-script SOC automation pipeline), PowerShell 7 (monitoring, forensics, pipeline orchestration), Bash, Git/GitHub, GitHub Actions CI/CD
- InfrastructureProxmox VE 9.1 (8-VM role-segmented estate), ZFS mirrored storage (opsvault), LVM-thin, Tailscale overlay networking, SMB evidence publishing, Docker (Cowrie honeypot, Grafana), GPU passthrough (Tesla V100)
- FrameworksMITRE ATT&CK, SOC triage methodology, incident response fundamentals, evidence chain discipline, proof-first portfolio architecture
- Security ToolsWazuh, Splunk, Sigma, Sysmon (endpoint instrumentation), Cowrie honeypot, Tailscale, Windows Security Event log analysis
- DocumentationTechnical runbooks, IR playbooks (7-step structured format), evidence packs, post-incident reports, SOC handoff documentation, IATF 16949 audit documentation (prior career)
- CertificationsCompTIA Security+ SY0-701 — exam scheduled April 2026 | ISC2 CC — in progress | Anthropic MCP, Claude API, Claude Code — completed 2026

SECURITY OPERATIONS EXPERIENCE

SOC Operations Analyst — SignalFoundry / AutoSOC PipelineSep 2025 – Present

HawkinsOps (Self-Directed) — hawkinsops.com • Gadsden, AL

- SignalFoundry Architecture:** Designed and built SignalFoundry — a production-grade 7-stage SOC triage pipeline: Wazuh alert ingest → policy-driven triage → mandatory redaction → evidence pack assembly → ledger reconciliation → coverage/quality gate → gated proof publication. Nothing publishes without PASS.
- Pipeline processed 49,774 ledger-verified cases across 8 monitored endpoints — 8/8 host coverage, zero reconciliation mismatches, 2,478 published analyst-ready evidence packs committed to public proof repository as of March 20, 2026 canonical snapshot

- Authored and tuned 103 Sigma rules across 10 MITRE ATT&CK tactics, 28 Wazuh XML rule blocks across 24 XML files, 8 Splunk SPL detection queries, and 10 structured 7-step IR playbooks — 139 total detection artifacts, all script-verified against repository
- Stress-tested pipeline March 2–4, 2026: 25,167 cases processed in 72 hours at 90.1% auto-close rate — forensically validated, date-attributed, documented as public portfolio artifact
- Diagnosed and recovered multi-domain pipeline fault on March 13, 2026 — isolated sequential poller timeout and reconciliation serialization defect under production load, restored end-to-end reconciliation to SUCCESS; documented as case study
- Conducted live Splunk threat hunting session on own endpoint (HO-WE-01): EventID 4688 analysis, rex-based field extraction from scratch, parent-process exclusion logic — surfaced Codex AI tool spawning pwsh.exe 375 times, correctly classified as tool behavior vs LOLBin abuse pattern; publishable technical finding
- Built and operates role-segmented Proxmox infrastructure: HO-RUNNER-01 (orchestration), HO-WAZUH-01 (SIEM), HO-SPLUNK-01 (investigation layer), HO-GPU-01 (Tesla V100 passthrough), HO-GRAFANA-01, HO-HONEYPOT-01 (Cowrie), HO-WIN11-01 (monitored endpoint), plus file service and templates — 8 active VMs, 2 TiB RAM, mirrored ZFS storage
- Implemented drift-scan enforcement, CI-verified public metrics, canonical metrics.json as single source of truth, and drift-controlled public proof surfaces — all public claim counts are generated from repo artifacts, not hand-edited
- Built 277+ GitHub commits, 35-script Python automation pipeline (run-factory.ps1 orchestrated), 20+ PowerShell monitoring and forensics scripts; CI/CD via GitHub Actions; deployed on Cloudflare Pages

AI Model Evaluator — Cybersecurity & Technical Domain

Dec 2025 – Present

Outlier / DataAnnotation (Contract) • Remote

- Evaluate AI-generated outputs for technical accuracy, logical consistency, and security domain correctness across cybersecurity, detection engineering, and systems administration prompts
- Applied multi-model triangulation methodology (Claude, ChatGPT, Gemini) as epistemological cross-validation practice — developed systematic approach to identifying AI reasoning errors, hallucination patterns, and capability boundaries
- Bridges income during HawkinsOps build phase; provides direct exposure to AI model behavior that informs detection engineering work around AI-assisted tooling in enterprise environments

OPERATIONAL FOUNDATION — PRODUCTION → SECURITY BRIDGE

Prior career in Tier 1 automotive manufacturing (IATF 16949 / ISO 9001 / TISAX) provides direct operational transfer into SOC work. The cognitive operations are structurally identical — the domain changed, the instinct did not. Documented with 232 timestamped photographs from inside active Tier 1 Nissan/Honda stamping facilities.

Downtime Event	→	Security Incident
Defect / Nonconforming Part	→	Alert / Detection Hit
Escalation Path (TL → Supervisor)	→	Triage Escalation (Tier 1 → Tier 2)
SOP / Standardized Work	→	IR Playbook
Shift Handoff Documentation	→	Case Notes / SOC Handoff
Root Cause Analysis	→	Post-Incident Analysis
4M Change Tracking Board	→	Change Point Management
Press Fault Tree (Notebook)	→	Alert Triage Decision Tree

Production Supervisor — Hot Stamp & Laser Operations

Mar 2025 – Dec 2025

Unipres Alabama, Inc. (Tier 1 — Nissan & Honda) • Steele, AL

- Supervised 30+ operators on 3,000-ton transfer press and 5 TRUMPF 3D laser cutting machines; enrolled in Floor Supervisor Training Plan — Hot Stamp & Laser Department within first week of employment
- Maintained 4M Summary Board, Stamping Production Reports, Downtime Calculator — documented fault trees and press recovery procedures in notebooks before owning a personal computer; identical methodology to SOC triage decision trees
- IATF 16949:2016 / ISO 9001 environment; documented 424 minutes of categorized downtime with corrective action — same MTTD/MTTR mindset applied to SignalFoundry pipeline monitoring

Production Team Lead (promoted under 3 months)

Jan 2024 – Feb 2025

Fehrer Automotive North America, LLC (Tier 1 — Mercedes-Benz, BMW, Volkswagen, Tesla) • Gadsden, AL

- Led 20+ person team across three lines — up to 5,400 parts/shift; managed escalation paths, shift handoffs, SOP compliance, and corrective action under IATF 16949 — same operational discipline now running SignalFoundry

CERTIFICATIONS & EDUCATION

- CompTIA Security+ SY0-701 — Exam scheduled April 2026
- ISC2 Certified in Cybersecurity (CC) — In progress, exam scheduled March 2026
- Anthropic MCP, Claude API, Claude Code Certifications — Completed 2026
- Forklift Operator — Active Certification (2025)
- IATF 16949:2016 / ISO 9001 / TISAX — direct working experience across two certified Tier 1 environments
- High School Diploma — Gadsden City High School, 2021

REFERENCES

- Josh Carlton — IT Manager, Unipres Alabama — 25-year IT veteran — donated enterprise server hardware (V100/2TiB) — reference letter in progress — contact available upon request
- Aveunta Poe — Production Supervisor, Fehrer Automotive North America — (256) 458-5307
- Ramade Williams — Hot Stamp Coordinator, Unipres Alabama — (256) 504-2764 — ramade.williams@unipres.com
- Calvin McCoy — Production Manager, Carrington Foods — (228) 437-7661

Full proof available at hawkinsops.com/proof • Case study at hawkinsops.com/case-study-autosoc • Eligible to obtain clearance • Willing to pursue sponsorship